

Difficult events

Every family experiences upsetting events and faces difficult challenges. These tough moments affect every family member. It can take time to accept new situations and to adjust to them.

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◀ 174–175 Parent-teen relationships

◀ 178–179 Dealing with conflict

Siblings

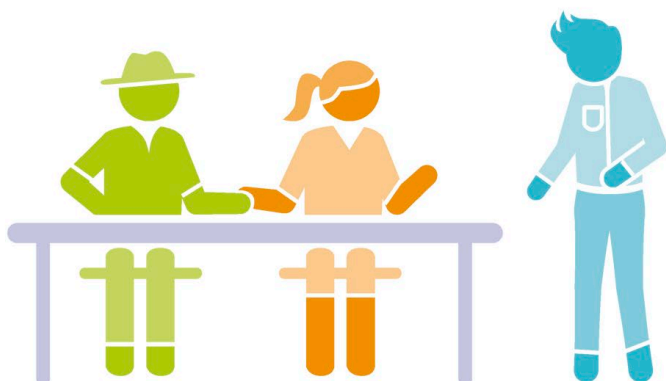
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Sharing big news

No one is ever really sure how to share big, perhaps upsetting, news. From sad news like a death in the family to exciting news of a new job, it's natural to feel uncertain. But discussing things as a family can help to ensure that everyone—teens and parents alike—feel included, important, and acknowledged.

▽ Sensitive subjects

Big news can be unsettling, especially for teens who are already coping with the changes of puberty.



PARENT TIPS

Sharing big news

- Choose what you're going to say in advance, keeping your message as clear as possible.
- Make it clear that it is okay to be upset.
- Allow questions, and give honest answers.
- Be reassuring about the impact this news will have on the family.

TEEN HINTS

Telling your parents something

- Decide in advance how much you want to tell your parents—but be as honest as you can be.
- Choose an appropriate time and place.
- You may not get the reaction you were expecting, so try to see your news from their perspective.
- If necessary, think about what actions should be taken after breaking the news.

Moving to a new place

Moving can be an adventure, but it can also feel like a loss of things and people that a teen knows and cares about. Parents can prepare teens for a move by explaining why it's necessary, the practicalities of the moving process, and the changes that will be involved, such as going to a new school. Discussing plans will help make the transition as smooth as possible, as will outlining a way to maintain current friendships. Helping to look at houses and schools in the new area, and with packing, can allow teens to feel part of these big decisions.

▽ New adventures

Moving can be daunting for parents and teens alike. Being aware of each other's feelings about the move can help to soothe uncertainty.

